

## A

## What do you do?

People can ask what job you do in different ways; you can answer in different ways.



A: **What do you do?**



B: I **work in** sales / marketing / a bank, etc.



A: **What do you do for a living?**



B: I'm a doctor / hairdresser, etc.



A: **What's your job?**



B: I **work for** Union Bank / Fiat / Sony, etc.

## B

## What does that involve?\*

James and Emma are business **consultants** [people who help others in a particular area]. They **advise** people who want to **set up** [start] a business, especially in health and fitness. James **deals with** the marketing [does the work in marketing; *syn* **handle**], while Emma is **responsible for** [in control of; *syn* **in charge of**] **products** [things that people make/**produce**] such as towels, equipment, beauty products, etc.

## Common mistakes

I have a lot of work to do. (NOT I have a lot of ~~works~~ to do.)

She **advises** me. (NOT She ~~advices~~ me.) BUT She gives me **advice**. (NOT She gives me ~~advise~~.)

My job involves a lot of travel. OR My job involves travelling. (NOT My job involves ~~to travel~~.)

Amy is a manager in a veterinary surgery. She **runs** [organises or controls] the **day-to-day** [happening every day] business of the surgery and is in charge of a small team: three receptionists, an accounts manager and a secretary. Her work involves a lot of **admin** [short for administration] such as buying food, medicine and equipment; she also handles any **complaints** that customers make. [when customers **complain** / say that something is wrong or is not satisfactory]

\* What do you have to do exactly?

## C

## Pay

Most workers **are paid** [receive money] every month; this is called a **salary**. Your **income** is the total amount of money you receive in a year. This might be money from one job; it might be money from two jobs. We can express this in different ways:

My **income** is about £25,000. OR I **earn/make** about £25,000 **a year** [every year].

Some of that income you can keep, but some goes to the government; in the UK this is called **income tax**, e.g. *I lose 20% of my income in income tax.*

## Language help

A **salary** is money paid to professional people, e.g. doctors or teachers, and to office workers for the work they do, and is usually paid into a person's bank account every month. **Wages** are usually paid for each hour/day/week of work to people who do more physical jobs, e.g. building or cleaning.

## D

## Conditions\*

Most people work **fixed** hours [always the same], e.g. 9 am to 5.30 pm. We often call this a **nine-to-five** job. Other people have to **do/work overtime** [work extra hours]. Some people get paid for overtime; others don't. Some people have good working conditions, e.g. nice offices, paid holidays, extra time **off** [not at work] for a new mother and father when a baby is born, etc. There is also a **minimum wage** [an amount of money workers receive, and employers cannot pay less than this].

\* the situation in which people work or live